MONTHLY UPDATE

Legislation and regulation: monthly update, September – October 2026

Edition of 2026-10-12 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

> *38 places. Every block below is carried verbatim from that place's own monthly update, where it was written, sourced and checked; nothing is written here.*

ALGERIA · ANGOLA · BENIN · BURKINA FASO · BURUNDI · CAMEROON · CENTRAL AFRICAN REPUBLIC · CHAD · CONGO · COTE D'IVOIRE · DR CONGO · EGYPT · EQUATORIAL GUINEA · ERITREA · ESWATINI · ETHIOPIA · GABON · GAMBIA · GHANA · GUINEA-BISSAU · KENYA · LESOTHO · LIBYA · MADAGASCAR · MAURITIUS · MOZAMBIQUE · NAMIBIA · NIGER · NIGERIA · SENEGAL · SIERRA LEONE · SOUTH AFRICA · TANZANIA · TOGO · TUNISIA · UGANDA · ZAMBIA · ZIMBABWE

The place reports do not share one window; the period above is the range they span.

Algeria

The high commission for digitalisation says a digitalisation law covering data, digital services, electronic exchange, system security and the responsibilities attached to them is in the final stages of study; no draft, sponsor or timetable is published.

Angola

The statistics institute put a revision of the national statistical system law to public consultation from 29 September to 2 October 2026, after an extraordinary plenary of the national statistics council on 28 August. No draft text is held. The cybersecurity law was published as Lei n.º 9/26 of 28 September and is in force, revoking the 2017 law: it creates a national cybersecurity system with CERT.ao as the operational arm of its centre, and gives operators of critical infrastructure, essential services, electronic communications, data centres, cloud and digital services 180 days to register with the centre, with a duty to set up incident response teams and notify significant incidents. The gazetted text is not held. The authorisation became Lei de Autorização Legislativa n.º 12/26 of 2 October 2026, giving the President 90 days to legislate the electronic signature and digital certification regime.

Benin

The framework statute reached into the workplace. On a newspaper's reading of article 379 of the Code du numérique, a company phone, a company-issued number or a work messaging group does not by itself entitle an employer to read the messages on it. It is a reading rather than a regulator decision or a judgment, and the repository holds no enforcement action on workplace monitoring. The audiovisual and communication regulator signed conventions with 89 online radio, television and press outlets on 1 October, closing its authorisation process; the number of applicants refused is not stated.

Burkina Faso

Civil status abroad got a new legal base: the Council of Ministers adopted a decree on 10 September replacing the 1963 rules on diplomatic and consular civil-status powers and introducing mobile consular missions.

Burundi

The Senate unanimously adopted the access to information bill on 29 September 2026, after its committee reviewed the government's and the National Assembly's versions. The bill creates a National Commission on Access to Public Information that hears appeals and a duty to publish certain information within 30 days, with exceptions for national security, private life and ongoing judicial investigations and no statutory ceiling on access fees. The account rests on a Senate committee report as read by one outlet; no text is published. Mandatory SIM registration, begun in mid-June, was about 70 per cent complete on the regulator's count, amid long queues, few service points, slow systems and continuing scams; operators must keep customer data for at least five years.

Cameroon

The telecommunications regulator gave operators until 30 September 2026 to file identification forms for a public directory of licensed operators; nothing is yet published. A policy institute's brief of 4 September argues the 2010 cybercrime law is outdated, citing cyberattacks up 156% between 2020 and 2023 and the national ICT agency's cybercrime unit at 23% of its establishment.

Central African Republic

The statistics institute reported that the bill replacing the statistics law of 16 July 2001 had passed technical validation and strategic review and awaits the commission that examines draft official texts.

Chad

Chad's digital statutes entered the repository this month by being listed, not by being made. The regulator's register names the 2015 laws on cybersecurity, electronic transactions and personal data protection as the laws it works under and links the text of none; the statistics institute names Loi n. 026/PR/2019 and four decrees.

On payments there is nothing national to name at all: the central bank's register gives the regional payment systems regulation of December 2016 as the instrument in force. A payments law that is regional and a practice that runs on conventions with four operators leave no statute a citizen can be pointed to.

The Council of Ministers adopted a draft labour code on 3 September that replaces the 1996 law and brings digital platform workers under a presumption of salaried status; it is not yet before the legislature.

Congo

On 17 September the prime minister said the 2001 law on freedom of information and communication must be updated for social networks, disinformation and artificial intelligence, and the media fair's closing resolutions recommended its reform. The resolutions come from media professionals; no draft has been announced. The money-transfer regulator said it will enforce article 13 of the 2026 finance law, which requires every operator to register on its digital platform and declare all transfers monthly, on pain of a FCFA 20 million fine. The transfer regulator said it will enforce the use of electronic payment terminals by every money-transfer operator from January 2027, after showing 200 of 1,000 terminals ordered to about a hundred operators in Brazzaville.

Cote d'Ivoire

An analysis published on 10 September sets out the banking reform that brings financial technology firms into the regulated perimeter: two bills adopted by the Council of Ministers on 29 April 2026, under which competition between banks, payment institutions, electronic money issuers and fintechs turns on licences and their obligations. No adoption by parliament is on record. The telecoms regulator's head, speaking on World Post Day, 9 October 2026, called for the postal network to be adapted to the digital economy; the report records a revision of the 2013 Postal Code under way.

DR Congo

Deputy Alfred Dibandi Nzondomyo filed a private member's bill on the protection of minors in the digital environment with the National Assembly on 21 September, framed as a special law beside the Code du numérique and the child-protection law, with rules for children under six and under eleven and stronger provisions for under-15s. The text is not published. The Senate declared admissible on 28 September a senator's bill amending the Digital Code to bar children under 13 from social platforms, with supervised accounts from 13 to 15 and mandatory age verification; it went to a joint committee.

Egypt

The telecoms regulator said on 18 September that it is preparing a comprehensive digital-safety law with the House of Representatives' ICT committee, to sit beside the joint decision on children's accounts; no draft is published.

The Financial Regulatory Authority's Decision No. 2735 of 2026 gives consumer and small-business finance companies two months to verify customers by one-time password, and a protocol signed on 16 September requires the media council to take the authority's technical opinion, within fifteen days, before licensing any app that carries on non-bank financial activity or uses a supervised firm's name. On 1 September two more fintech projects received preliminary approval to enter the authority's sandbox.

The ministry's investment conference on 7 September carried a session on the data-protection executive regulations alongside ICT investment, artificial intelligence and startup finance, seven weeks before the compliance period closes on 1 November. No guidance, decision or transfer licence issued under the regulations is on the record. The House ICT committee's newly elected chair said the digital-safety bill heads the committee's agenda for the new session and mostly regulates children's use of social media; no text is published. The chair of the House communications committee said the new session would open with the digital safety bill, which gives priority to protecting children on social media.

Equatorial Guinea

The press bill cleared the lower house: the Chamber of Deputies unanimously approved on 11 September the bill replacing the 1997 press law, which covered no digital journalism.

The 2024 social-media and computer-crime law was used in court for the first time on the public record. On 16 September lawyers for the vice-president lodged four criminal complaints at a Malabo investigating court against a digital newspaper's journalist and three others under articles 2, 50 and 60, using article 2 to reach conduct committed outside the country. The complaints came while Facebook and TikTok remained blocked.

A Senate committee approved by consensus its final report on the press freedom bill and sent it to the plenary.

Eritrea

The central bank tightened its hold on cash a second time. After the June order to deposit holdings by 31 July, Legal Notice No. 134/2026 of 9 September caps the cash an individual may keep beyond 15 days at 25,000 nakfa, and private institutions at 50,000, 100,000 or 150,000 nakfa by grade, in force on publication. The notice is known through a human-rights group's statement rather than its own text, and that statement records no cash machines or cards and thin branch access outside the main towns. Neither what counts as an acceptable reason for holding more nor the penalty is defined.

Eswatini

In the same 4 August answer, the ICT ministry said it had completed the Online Media Publishing Guidelines 2026, introducing a registration requirement for online publishers bound to accuracy, privacy protection, child safeguarding and the responsible use of AI. Neither the text nor a commencement date is public.

An Immigration Bill would let a system-generated communication bar a foreign national's entry, at an implementation cost of about E6 million, with no appeal route described.

Ethiopia

The Council of Ministers approved a draft National Data Management Proclamation at its 59th regular meeting on 28 September 2026 and referred it to the House of Peoples' Representatives. It is framed as strengthening data security and sovereignty and enabling data sharing and reuse across government systems. No text is published.

Gabon

The Council of Ministers at Port-Gentil on 18 September 2026 adopted a decree setting how qualified electronic-signature certificates and other trust services are issued. It covers electronic signatures and seals, website authentication, the electronic stamp, the standardised e-invoice and the e-visa, with accreditation conditions for providers. Its publication in the official journal is not held. Draft legal texts on digital infrastructure, cybersecurity, digital services and the institutional framework went to a validation review of about ten days at Nkok from 1 October, under the World Bank-financed digital programme; the texts are not held.

Gambia

The National Assembly committed the Competition and Consumer Protection Commission Bill 2026 after its second reading on 15 September. It would replace the 2007 competition and 2014 consumer protection Acts with a single independent commission.

Ghana

The legislative programme itself got a ministerial account on 7 September: under a World Bank-backed acceleration project, a review of fifteen pieces of ICT legislation is about half complete, with stakeholder consultation already finished on part of it. An IMF technical assistance report finds the two regulators' crypto guidelines short of comprehensive oversight, with the regime under the Virtual Asset Service Providers Act set to go live in December 2026, and urges activity-based guidelines, finalised stablecoin rules and a transitional licensing regime; it puts annual crypto transactions at around US$21bn.

Guinea-Bissau

A Bissau law professor told an ECOWAS Court conference in Dakar on 22 September that a draft law would create a data protection agency, its organisation left to decree, and that the country still has no dedicated data protection law or authority. No bill text or date is held.

Kenya

The fifteen draft communications regulations went through a three-day stakeholder validation workshop convened by the ICT ministry with the regulator, reported on 23 September; the remaining statutory stages are still to come. Public comment on the National Payment System Bill runs to 9 October, on a law firm's account of the notice. Regulations for non-deposit-taking credit providers were gazetted, revoking the 2022 digital credit rules, with separate consent for personal data and human review of AI lending decisions.

Lesotho

The Cybersecurity Bill 2026 then went back to stakeholders: its draft was circulated for review in August and taken to a second consultation workshop on 23 September, proposing a two-tier regulatory regime and the registration of cybersecurity professionals.

The communications ministry took the Electronic Transactions and Communications Bill, 2026 to a stakeholder validation workshop in Maseru from 28 September, with UNDP support. It revises the unenacted 2022 Bill and goes next to the Office of the Parliamentary Counsel; the revised text is not held.

Libya

Trade was tied to the banking system and to a register. Importing goods for trade outside banking channels is prohibited from 30 September 2026 under decision 449 of 2026, which ties import operations to banking and customs procedures and to registration on the unified digital trade system, and the capital's chamber of commerce has met on whether the date can be met and what the decision will cost its members.

Madagascar

The extraordinary session ended without passing a digital law. The National Assembly deferred five bills to a later session on 4 September, the recast cybercrime law and the electronic communications and digital infrastructure bill first among them, the deputies saying they needed longer on texts turning on both security imperatives and fundamental freedoms and the Assembly's president saying he did not care to imagine what would have followed had they not deferred. The cybercrime bill would create a digital protection and investigation unit and, under article 75, give it permanent round-the-clock technical access to operators' systems; commentary reads the contested articles as written to suit the state's own control interests. A third bill, authorising ratification of the United Nations Convention against Cybercrime, went to parliament on 28 August with the cybercrime recast and was deferred with it. The session that opened on 17 September lists seventeen bills and neither digital bill among them, its order paper set by presidential decree; no bill text is published. The electronic communications bill, submitted to the Assembly on 28 August, waits for a future session; its text, 140 articles, would end every monopoly in the sector with no transitional period and oblige data-centre operators to keep data on national territory.

Mauritius

A third bill was set out in public rather than in print. The ICT minister said the Road Traffic (Amendment) Bill would make the digital driving licence an official electronic version equivalent to the traditional one and let holders settle fixed traffic penalties at any court and, above all, online, putting the affected population at more than 800,000 licence holders and saying the licence depends on interconnecting transport services, law enforcement and public administration. The Bill text is not held and no enactment or commencement date is stated.

The 2025 law on electronic transferable records was used for the first time. A commercial bank took five electronic bills of exchange from a trading group, created in under 30 minutes and transferred in under an hour, under the Finance Act 2025 amendment that made Mauritius the first African jurisdiction to adopt the UNCITRAL model law on the subject. The ICT minister said on 29 September that the provisions for paying fines online take effect on 30 October 2026, for fines carrying no penalty points; the Bill's enactment is not on record. The ICT ministry and Meta are to discuss a framework agreement on online safety at working sessions on 6 and 7 October, covering moderation of content in Mauritian Creole, child protection, takedown requests and a possible requirement for local representation; nothing is signed. A law firm's reading has the amendment Act recognise electronic transferable records and contracts formed by automated message systems. The ICT ministry held its working session with Meta on faster content removal, Kreol moderation and proposed amendments to the Cybersecurity and Cybercrime Act, with no framework yet signed.

The government said bills and amendments on cybersecurity, cybercrime and the ICT Act are in preparation, and the minister described a framework agreement being negotiated with a platform operator on takedowns and verified identities. No text or date is published.

Mozambique

On 15 September the Council of Ministers approved a Postal Security Regulation setting controls against fraud, theft and cyber threats to the postal network as e-commerce parcels grow; its text is not held.

A law regulating artificial intelligence in education is almost ready and will reach the Council of Ministers before the end of 2026, the minister said in an account of 17 September, covering every institution from primary school to university. No draft text is published.

Namibia

The non-bank financial regulator said on 21 September that the Financial Institutions and Markets Act and the NAMFISA Act, in operation from 1 May 2026, frame its approach to fintech and consumer protection.

Niger

Online media are to be brought under dedicated rules: the Council of Ministers adopted a draft ordinance on the electronic press and a decree on accrediting foreign correspondents on 10 September.

The online press answered the draft ordinance in its own name: fourteen editors welcomed the text on 13 September and asked to be consulted on the rules that will apply it.

Nigeria

The platform penalty moved toward a deal: Meta is negotiating a settlement with the commission after a first appeal was rejected, on a single paywalled account. The Nigerian Fintech Regulatory Commission Bill passed second reading in the House of Representatives in October 2025 and had a public hearing on 2 March 2026; it would create a single licensing gateway beside the central bank and the securities regulator, and is still pending.

Lagos State said it is working on an innovation bill to give research and innovation incentives, dedicated funding and a legal basis, with no timeline.

Senegal

On 24 September the head of the interior ministry's file-automation directorate said a text extending the validity of the first ECOWAS biometric identity cards, issued in 2016 and nearing expiry, has had committee work at the National Assembly and still needs a vote, promulgation and an implementing decree. The length of the extension and the cards covered are not fixed; ordinary renewal stays open. The text, bill 21/2026, was adopted in committee and taken in plenary on 29 September; the plenary sent it back to committee that day on a motion by the law committee's chair, who raised procurement, the use of national firms and foreign custody of citizens' data. The interior minister had told the committee the card contract with the Malaysian supplier ends on 21 May 2027, too soon to renew every card.

Sierra Leone

A Digital Government Bill with data-governance and child-protection provisions is being prepared with the Attorney-General's office, with no draft or timetable published.

South Africa

Parliament's justice committee agreed on 23 September that the department may publish proposed amended court rules for access-to-information applications, standardising section 78 applications across all courts, requiring sworn section 80 representations five days before a hearing and repealing the old rules. They are proposals, not yet in force.

Tanzania

The Citizen Budget 2026/27, published on 22 September, lists the digital service tax on foreign digital service providers as raised from 2% to 3%. Its effective date and statutory clause are not stated.

A legal update drew attention to regulations in force since 1 July 2026 that make proof of a digital payment facility, such as Lipa Namba or TANQR, a condition of every new or renewed business licence; the Government Notice was published on 30 June 2026.

Togo

On 22 September the communication regulator HARC held its first official meeting with content creators, bloggers and influencers, asserting a remit over social-media content under article 78 of the 2024 Constitution and saying advertising on social networks should in principle take its prior visa. The communication ministry said the 2020 press and communication code would be revised to cover them; no draft or timetable is published. The Council of Ministers adopted a bill authorising ratification of the convention governing the Banking Commission of the West African Monetary Union, examining four bills and adopting three together with one decree. Neither the convention nor the

bill is held, no parliamentary timetable is stated, and what ratification changes for supervision of digital finance here is not described. The civil status law review ran a technical workshop for the cell carrying it, a month after the review formally opened. No draft text or adoption date is published.

Tunisia

Compulsory electronic invoicing reached the liberal professions: registration of about 380,000 providers on the platform opened on 15 September. The date rests on a tax adviser's radio account, and no official instrument fixing it is held.

The central bank's circular 2026-10 of 25 September replaced the 2018 payment-establishments circular, allowing three tiers of payment account, remote account opening on reliable identity verification and a 3,000-dinar cap on cash transfers, in force three months after publication. The physicians' order maintained its reservation on applying compulsory electronic invoicing to medicine in its present form, citing medical secrecy and patients' data. The social affairs minister said the remote-work bill was ready and completing its final administrative stages, and that a legal text on the platform economy had been prepared.

Uganda

January's shutdown directive reached the record in its own words. A newspaper republished the Uganda Communications Commission text in full on 7 September: made on the Inter-Agency Security Committee's recommendation, it suspended public internet access, the sale and registration of new SIM cards and outbound data roaming to One Network Area countries across mobile, fibre, leased line, fixed wireless, microwave and satellite; ordered operators to disable mobile VPN services and block any public bypass; whitelisted an exclusion list covering national referral hospital systems, core banking and clearing, tax and government payment gateways, immigration, electoral commission portals, voter verification and result tabulation, utilities, air traffic control and railway signalling; required incident reporting within 30 minutes; and required any operator unable to comply to shut down its entire internet infrastructure, on pain of fines or licence suspension. The directive the repository held was a scanned PDF with no text layer.

Digital lending came before Parliament's accountability committee. The central bank governor said on 14 September that the bank will investigate claims that the mobile money operators it supervises helped digital lenders take repayments from the wallets of people who never guaranteed the loans; both large operators denied deducting money without consent and asked the communications regulator to block unlicensed lending apps.

Zambia

The regulator removed an operator from the market. It revoked a network and service licence with effect from 14 September, citing persistent failures to meet regulatory, operational and financial obligations, after assessing the operator's representations.

The technology ministry opened consultations on amending the Electronic Communications and Transactions Act No. 4 of 2021, with a Lusaka Province meeting reported on 30 September: the amendment, approved in principle by Cabinet in September 2025, would end the tie between licensing certification and time-stamping providers and critical-information-infrastructure designation, and strengthen the national public key infrastructure under ZICTA. No draft text is published.

Zimbabwe

Cabinet granted e-hailing platforms a five-month moratorium on 9 September 2026 while a statutory instrument on their operations is prepared. The ICT minister said on 18 September that an E-Commerce and E-Transactions Bill is in preparation; no draft or tabling date is published.

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